

Track B Lab Guide

The 2D Art and 3D Model Pipeline: Generate » Clean Up » Approve

Prepared for Panteon Games — Codeo · August 2026 · Art + Tech Art · 15:15 – 16:45

This guide accompanies two labs: in Lab 1 you will produce a 2D event visual on a style-consistent pipeline and prepare it for approval; in Lab 2 you will generate a 3D asset from an approved 2D concept, clean it up and bring it into Unity. In both labs the real product is not the image but the process: the provenance record, the checklist and a reasoned approval decision.

PREREQUISITES

- ☐ Your Scenario account is open; the sample studio style model is visible in your account.
- ☐ Your Meshy (and, if available, Tripo) account is open. No access? Ask the instructor for the backup asset set.
- ☐ The coin-rush-workshop Unity project opens on your machine (for Lab 2's Unity import step).
- ☐ The art approval checklist (appendix to this guide) is printed or open.

LAB 1 · 2D: GENERATE » CLEAN UP » SUBMIT FOR APPROVAL (15:30 – 16:00)

1. Generate with the style model

Pick the sample studio style model and produce an event visual to the given brief: 3 variations. Write the prompt you used into the provenance record — it is the prompt library's first entry.

2. Derive the variants

From your chosen variation, derive the size variants (banner, square, portrait) and one localization variant. Use the batch flow; do not generate them one by one.

3. Clean up

Upscale » remove the background » crop. Export a sprite sheet for the variant headed into the game.

4. Fill in the checklist

Complete the attached art approval checklist for your visual; attach the provenance record (tool, model version, prompt).

5. Cross-approval rehearsal

Approve or reject your neighbor's package — whatever the decision, write the reasoning. Rejection reasons are fed back into the prompt library.

The 3D part opens with a short presentation at 16:00; Lab 2 starts at 16:15.

APPENDIX · ART APPROVAL CHECKLIST (V1)

#	Check	Criterion
1	Style consistency	Side by side with the studio's approved style reference set, the visual does not stand apart
2	Copyright similarity	No obvious similarity to known works / competitor game assets
3	Provenance record	Tool, model version and prompt recorded in full
4	Technical spec	Resolution, format and sprite sheet layout meet the spec
5	Text/logo cleanliness	No unwanted text, signatures or artifacts
6	License	The tool and model used are licensed for production use

Extra row for 3D assets: technical budget compliance (triangle count, texture size, LODs per the budget table below).

LAB 2 · 3D: GENERATE » CLEAN UP » BRING INTO UNITY (16:15 – 16:45)

6. Pick a concept

Take one of the 2D concepts that passed approval in Lab 1. We do not start 3D from an unapproved concept — that is how the pipeline works.

7. Generate image-to-3D

Make 2–3 quick attempts with Tripo (a base mesh in seconds). Carry the best result into the Meshy flow: texture generation; if time remains, the auto-rig.

8. Clean up

Bring the triangle count down to your asset class's budget with retopology; produce at least one LOD. Check the UV layout and texture size.

9. Bring into Unity

Import into the sample project: are scale, materials and shading correct? Round-trip test: export and re-import — is anything lost?

10. Submit for approval

Package it with the checklist + technical budget proof (a triangle-count screenshot); run the cross-approval rehearsal.

MOBILE POLYGON / TEXTURE BUDGET (STARTING POINT)

Asset class	Triangle budget	Texture	LOD
Main character / hero	15–30k	2×2048 PBR	3 levels
Standard unit / NPC	3–8k	1024	2–3 levels
Scene prop	0.5–3k	512–1024 atlas	2 levels
Background / decor	≤1k	atlas share	1–2 levels

These values are a starting suggestion for today's lab; after the closing they are calibrated against Panteon's real projects and go into the playbook.

TROUBLESHOOTING / BACKUP PLAN

Symptom	Fix
No Scenario access	Get the pre-generated image set from the instructor; continue from Step 3
Meshy queue is slow	Skip the rig step and settle for the texture; or continue from Step 8 with the backup raw mesh set
Triangle count won't come down to budget	Retopologize again against the next LOD target; move detail into the normal map
Materials broken in Unity	Change the export format (FBX/gITF); relink the texture paths
Wrong scale	Fix the scale factor in the import settings; note the unit setting in the source tool

GETTING READY FOR THE CLOSING (16:40)

- ☐ Your cleaned-up 3D asset is standing in a Unity scene (take a screenshot).
- ☐ You have the completed checklists and provenance records for Lab 1 and Lab 2.
- ☐ You have flagged your best 2–3 prompts for the prompt library.
- ☐ You have written today's observation for T2 (art production time) into the baseline metrics template.